



ENGLAND FOOTBALL
LEARNING

Session programme

Passing and receiving to attack



Contents

Week one: connecting with teammates	3
Week two: the lions' den	5
Week three: around the clock	7
Week four: creating and exploiting space	9
Week five: eliminating the opposition	11
Week six: festival week	13

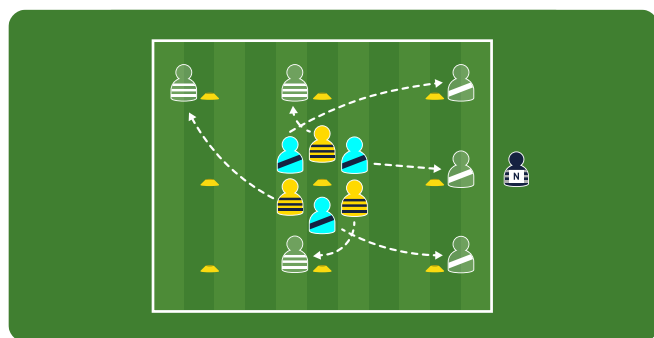
Week one: connecting with teammates

This session will help players:

- use scanning movement off the ball to connect with teammates on the ball
- make decisions on when and where to pass.

Coaching points

- Look for individual movement off-the-ball to see if players are aligning themselves with their teammate – and communicating with them – to make a connection.
- Emphasise the need to align the timing of the pass with the receiver's movement.
- Ask players to think about whether it's best for the pass to be into the receiver's feet or played into space.



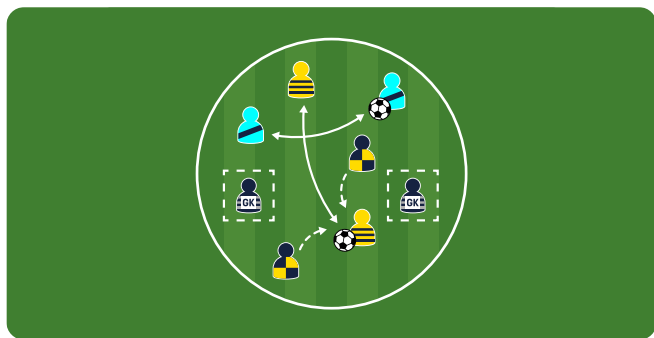
Arrival activity

- Create two 10x10-yard grids using nine cones for each one.
- Two teams of three start on the middle cone.
- On "Go", they run to form a three-in-a-row with their teammates.
- Teams get a point for successfully doing that.
- The first team to then do it three times, wins.



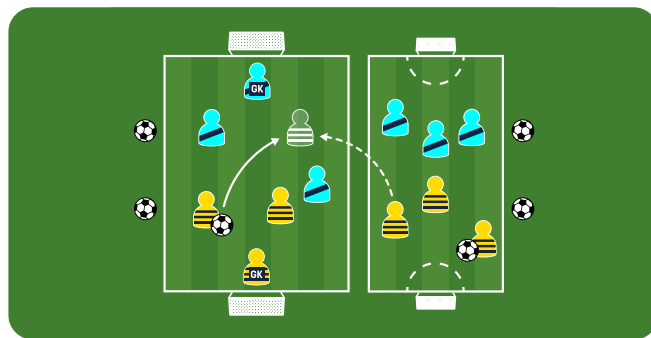
Practice one

- Create a circle with a ten-yard radius.
- Within that, place two small squares down. A goalkeeper stays inside each one.
- Pair the rest of the players up. Give each pair a ball.
- Teams look to pass between another pair. If the receiver then plays a first-time pass to the keeper, they earn a point.



Practice one – progression

- Progress this drill by making one of the pairs a pressing team to change this to an opposed practice.
- If the pressing team win the ball, they become a passing pair, and the team they took the ball from becomes the new pressing team.



Practice two

- Set up 30x20-yard and 30x30-yard pitches.
- On the smaller pitch use mini-goals.
- Use bigger goals and keepers on the other pitch.
- Begin with a matched-up game on each.
- Players can switch pitches to create overloads.
- Combine the scores on both pitches to find the winner after four minutes.

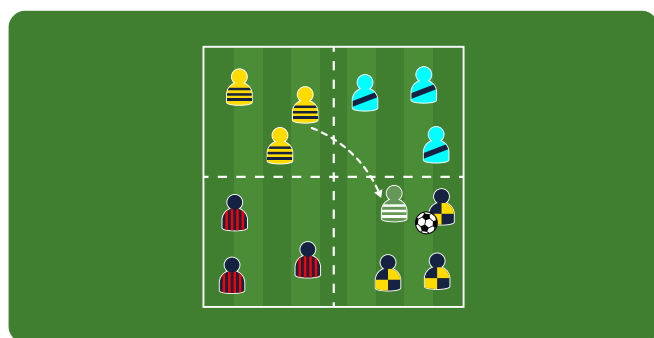
Week two: the lions' den

This session will help players:

- receive the ball in tight spaces
- develop confidence to receive the ball under pressure.

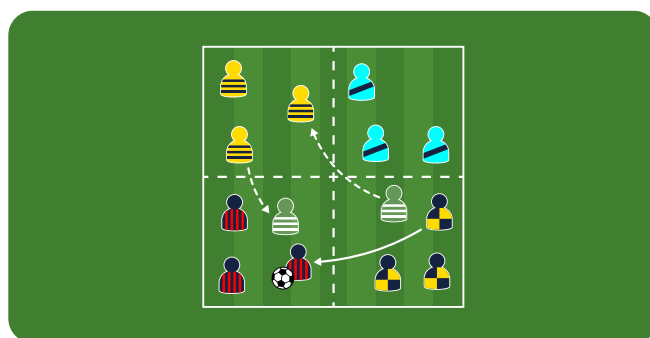
Coaching points

- Ask players to scan for 'BOTS' to gain key information before receiving the ball. This stands for; ball position, opposition players, teammates and space.
- Encourage players to vary their body positioning and technique when receiving the ball.
- Task players with using deception to outwit their opponent.
- During the last two drills, state the importance of offering supporting movement. When the player on the outside of the area receives the ball, good movement can help create space for the next pass.



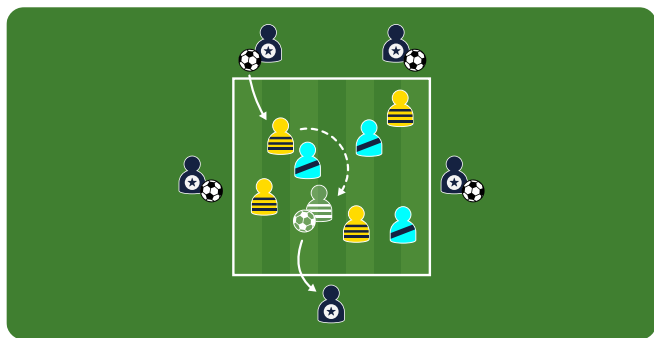
Arrival activity

- Create a 30x30-yard area and split it into four.
- Put three players in each grid to create four teams.
- Make one the pressing team.
- One of the other teams starts with a ball. They aim to make three passes between themselves while under pressure from a pressing player before passing it to another team.



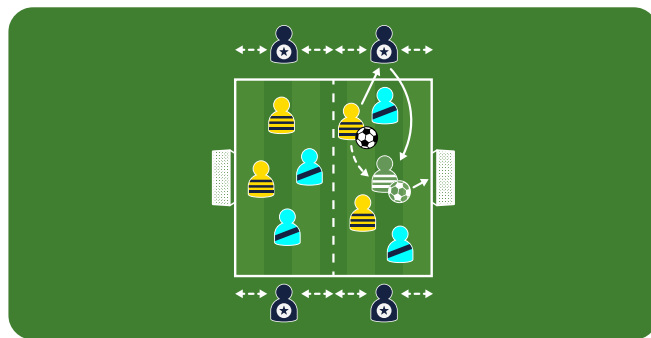
Arrival activity – continued

- The pressing team can only send one player out at a time and must change the player each time it goes to a new grid.
- If the pressing team do win the ball, the side they won the ball from becomes the new pressing team.



Practice one

- Set up a 30x30-yard area.
- Four attackers and three defenders are inside the area with five players around the outside of it.
- Give four of the outside players a ball.
- They pass to the attackers in the middle who, under pressure from defenders, try to pass to an outside player who doesn't have a ball.



Practice two

- Add two goals and a halfway line to the previous area.
- Have a 4v4 in the middle with four players on the outside.
- Players combine with teammates to score. But the team in possession can use the players on the outside.
- When a goal is scored, the outside players swap with the team that's conceded.

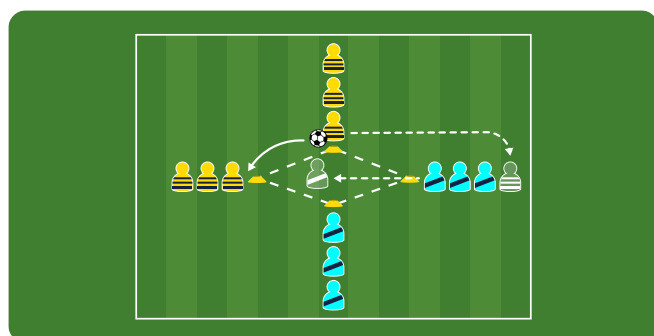
Week three: around the clock

This session will help players:

- make decisions on when to play forward
- explore receiving to turn forward and receiving to pass forward.

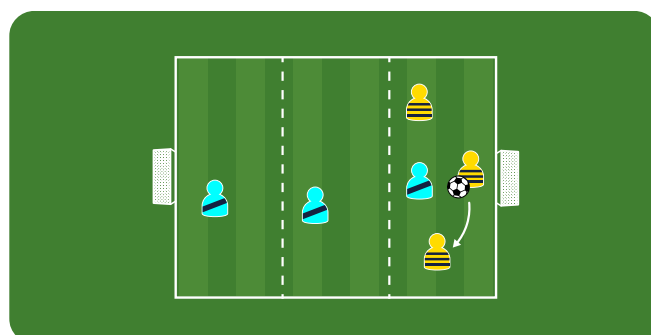
Coaching points

- Ask players to scan for 'BOTS' to gain key information before receiving the ball. This stands for; ball position, opposition players, teammates and space.
- Encourage players to receive on their back foot so they open their body out to see the next player they're looking to pass to.
- Challenge passers to think about where the receiver is to dictate what pass they need. If the receiver is in a tight area, the passer will need to play into their feet. If the receiver has more room, it might be beneficial for the passer to play the ball into space.
- Task players with using deception to outwit their opponent.



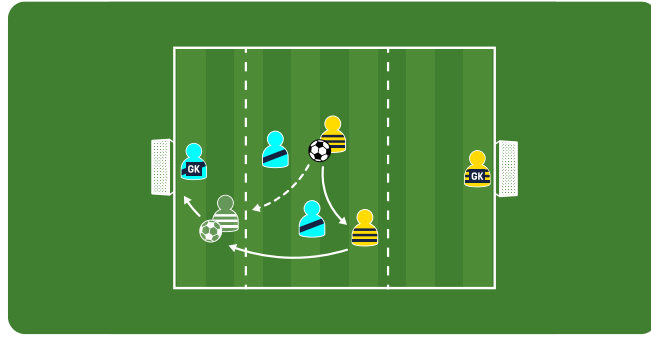
Arrival activity

- Create a 10x10-yard diamond area.
- Have three players on each cone.
- One player starts with the ball. They pass to the player to their right.
- While the passer runs to join the cone on their left, a player from that cone presses the receiver.
- The receiver passes to their right and the process repeats.



Practice one

- Create an 40x30-yard pitch that's split into thirds with a goal at each end.
- Have one defender locked in each third.
- Three attackers drive into the area and look to combine with each other to work through the thirds and score.
- If the defenders win the ball, they're unlocked and can combine to score.



Practice two

- Split a pitch into a 10-yard third, a 20-yard middle third and a 15-yard end third.
- Have a keeper in each end third with a 2v2 in the middle third.
- Teams can only shoot after a player receives a pass in the final third.
- Play for six minutes then swap ends to let teams experience receiving in the other third.

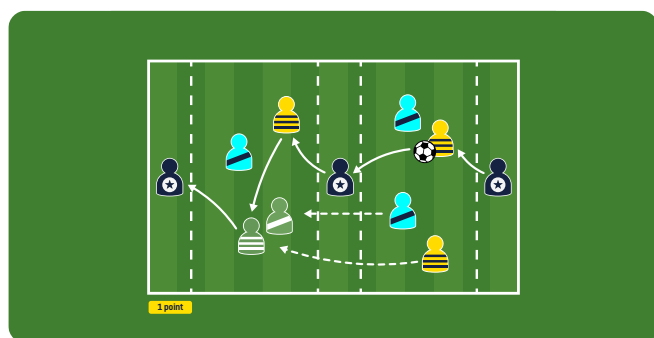
Week four: creating and exploiting space

This session will help players:

- combine with teammates, even in tight spaces
- work on passing range
- understand how use width, depth and height, to create space for individuals to receive.

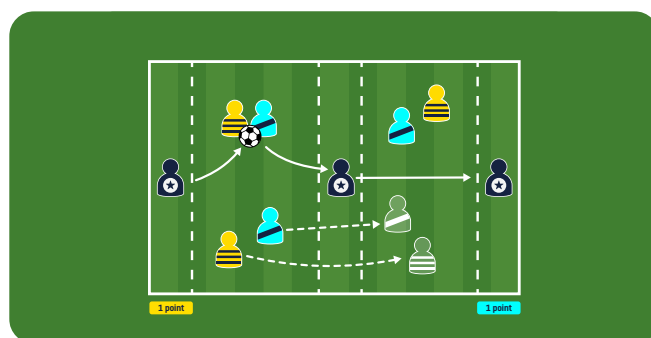
Coaching points

- Encourage players to create space through using width, depth and height with your teammates. For instance, if using width wisely in the first activity, it could open up space for the next pass – or for target players to pass to each other.
- Look for movement into space to receive and the timing of it.
- Observe if players are identifying spaces to exploit and using a varied range of passes to do so.
- Get players thinking about two-player and three-player core moves to help them combine with teammates successfully.



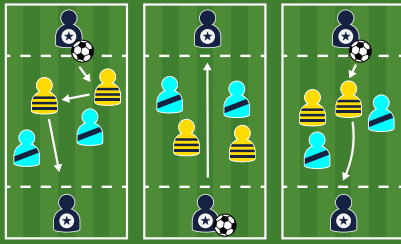
Practice one

- Create two 40x30-yard areas with zones at each end and one in the middle.
- Put a target player in each zone.
- Have a 2v2 and a 1v1 in between the zones.
- Attackers combine with target players to get the ball from one end to the other.
- When the ball is in the 1v1 zone players can join to make it a 2v2.



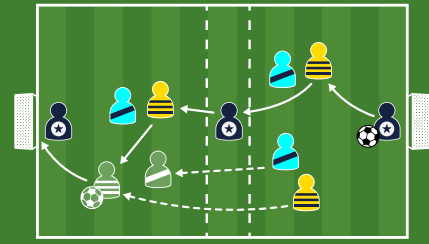
Practice one – continued

- Target players can pass to each other and players can play back to a target player if they cannot play forward.
- If the attackers successfully combine to get from one end to the other, they get a point and try to work it back to the other side.
- If the defenders win the ball, they become the attackers.



Practice two

- Create three 30x20-yard parallel pitches with end zones.
- Have a player in each end zone with a 2v2 in the middle.
- The aim is the same as the whole part of this practice – to combine with teammates to get the ball from one target player to the other.



Practice three

- Return to the first pitch but remove the end zones and replace them with a goal at each end.
- The target players at each end are now acting as the last defenders.
- The attackers combine to get the ball to the middle target player, then look to combine and score in the other half.

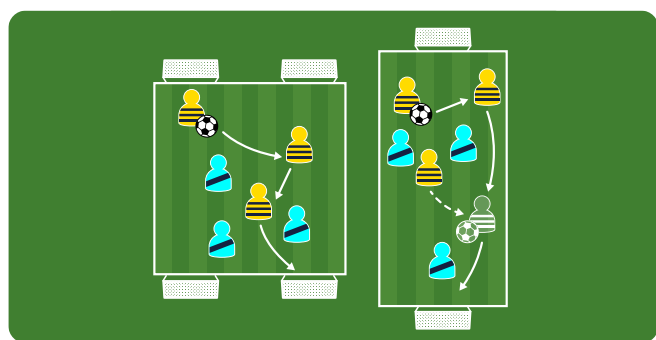
Week five: eliminating the opposition

This session will help players:

- combine to play forward
- explore ways to combine passes to eliminate opponents.

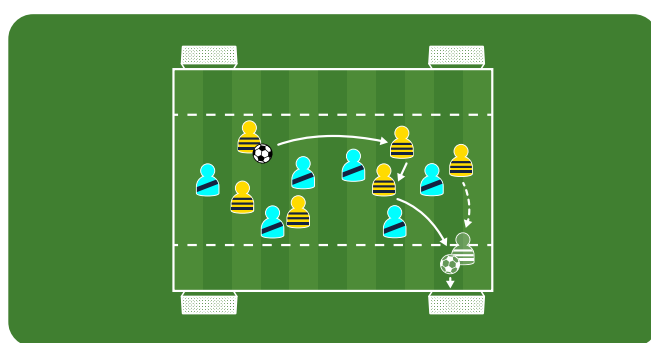
Coaching points

- Encourage players to create space through using width, depth and height effectively with your teammates.
- Look for movement into space to receive and the timing of it.
- Observe if players are identifying spaces to exploit and using a varied range of passes to do so.
- Get players thinking about two-player and three-player core moves to help them combine with teammates successfully.



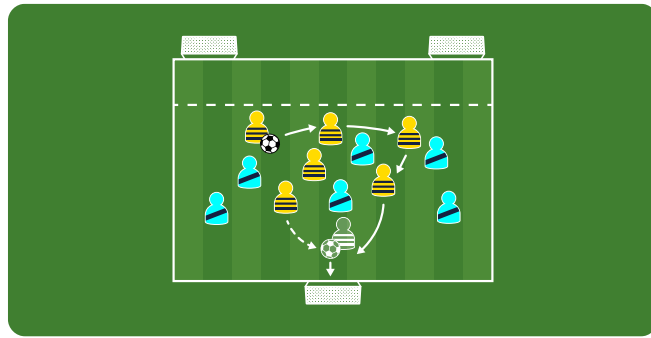
Arrival activity

- Set up parallel pitches. Create a 40x20-yard pitch with a goal at the centre of each end. And create a 30x30-yard pitch with two goals out wide at each end.
- Have a 3v3 on each pitch.



Practice one

- Create a 50x60-yard pitch with end zones and put a goal in each corner.
- Have a 6v6 in the middle.
- Players combine with teammates to play the ball through the opposition and into the end zone to set someone up to score.
- Defenders can't enter here, while attackers can only enter after the pass has been made.



Practice two

- Use the same area but remove a goal and the end zone at one end. Place the other goal in the centre.
- The team attacking the wide goals will focus on creating height, width and depth in their play.
- While the team attacking the single goal will play more centrally and into feet.
- After a while, swap ends.

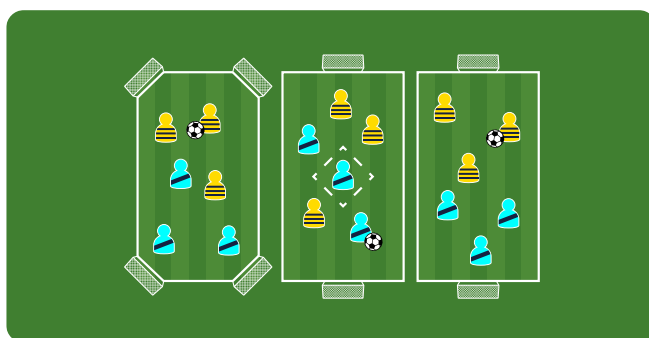
Week six: festival week

This session will help players:

- create and exploit space to connect with teammates
- decide whether to pass into space or feet
- decide whether to receive to turn or receive to pass.

Coaching points

- Encourage players to think about using height, width and depth to create space – and where they need to pass to best support their teammates.
- Try using drive-by coaching interactions. Take opportunities to move in and out of the games to give information to individuals with minimal disruption to ball-rolling time. Waiting for the ball to out of play is an ideal opportunity.



Festival carousel

- Create three 30x20-yard pitches for 3v3 games.
- On pitch one, put a goal in each corner.
- On pitch two, put a goal at each end with a diamond in the middle. Players can either play around the diamond or one can go in to play a pass unopposed.
- On pitch three, put a goal at each end.
- Rotate after five minutes.